



Western Australian Certificate of Education Examination, 2011

Question/Answer Booklet

PSYCHOLOGY

Stage 3

Please place your student identification label in this box

Student Number: In figures

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In words

Time allowed for this paper

Reading/planning time before commencing work: ten minutes

Working time for paper: three hours

Materials required/recommended for this paper

To be provided by the supervisor

This Question/Answer Booklet

To be provided by the candidate

Standard materials: pens, pencils, eraser, correction fluid/tape, ruler, highlighters

Special items: calculators satisfying the conditions set by the Curriculum Council for this course

Important note to candidates

No other materials may be taken into the examination room. It is **your** responsibility to ensure that you do not have any unauthorised notes or other material of a non-personal nature in the examination room. If you have any unauthorised material with you, hand it to the supervisor **before** reading any further.

Structure of this paper

Section	Number of questions available	Number of questions to be answered	Suggested working time (minutes)	Marks available	Percentage of exam
Section One: Research methods	3	3	30	20	20
Section Two: Short answer	5	5	90	50	50
Section Three: Extended answer	2	2	60	40	30
Total					100

Instructions to candidates

1. The rules for the conduct of Western Australian external examinations are detailed in the *Year 12 Information Handbook 2011*. Sitting this examination implies that you agree to abide by these rules.
2. Answer all questions by writing your answers in this booklet in the spaces provided.
3. You must be careful to confine your responses to the specific questions asked and to follow any instructions that are specific to a particular question.
4. Spare pages are included at the end of this booklet. They can be used for planning your responses and/or as additional space if required to continue an answer.
 - Planning: If you use the spare pages for planning, indicate this clearly at the top of the page.
 - Continuing an answer: If you need to use the space to continue an answer, indicate in the original answer space where the answer is continued, i.e. give the page number. Fill in the number of the question(s) that you are continuing to answer at the top of the page.

Section One: Research methods**20% (20 Marks)**

This section has **three (3)** questions. Answer **all** questions. Write your answers in the spaces provided.

Spare pages are included at the end of this booklet. They can be used as additional space if required to continue an answer. If you need to use the space to continue an answer, indicate in the original answer space where the answer is continued, i.e. give the page number. Fill in the number of the question(s) that you are continuing to answer at the top of the page.

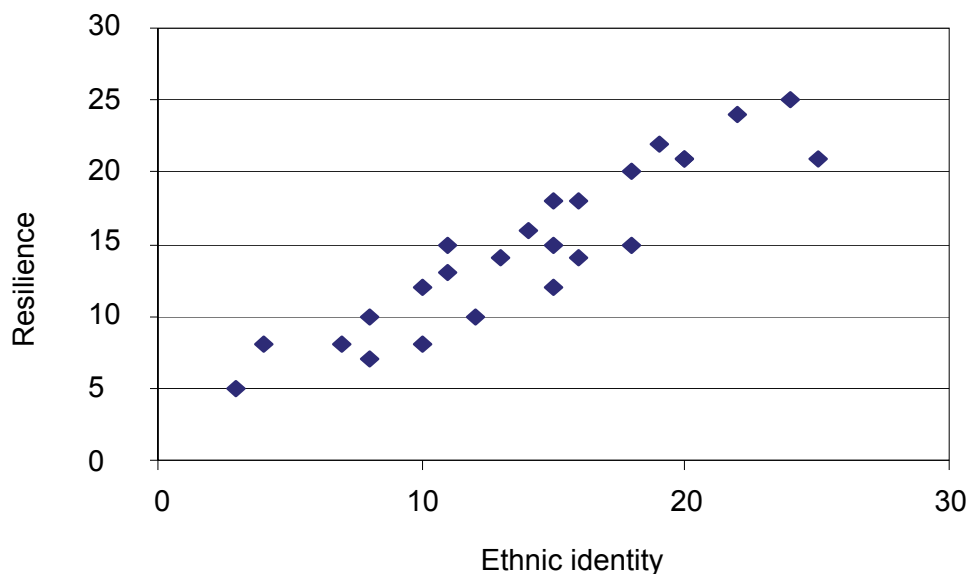
Suggested working time: 30 minutes.

Question 1**(6 marks)**

A psychologist was interested in the relationship between how strongly a person identifies with a particular ethnic group (ethnic identity) and their resilience to stress. The psychologist collected questionnaire measures of ethnic identity and resilience from 300 volunteer adults.

- (a) State an hypothesis that the psychologist could develop for this study. (1 mark)

The results of the study are shown in the scattergram below.



- (b) (i) Identify the nature of the relationship between the two variables shown in the scattergram. (1 mark)
-
- (ii) Do the results shown in the scattergram support the hypothesis stated in Question 1(a)? (1 mark)
-

See next page

- (c) (i) Describe a limitation of the research design used in this study that affects the conclusions that can be drawn from the results. (1 mark)

- (ii) Describe an alternative research design that the researchers could use to overcome the limitation identified in Question 1(c)(i). (2 marks)

Question 2

(6 marks)

A research study was conducted to determine the effectiveness of a herbal treatment for children with Attention Deficit/Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD). One hundred and twenty children aged 6-12 participated in the study. Eighty children in the Treatment group were given a herbal medicine for four months. The 40 children in the Control group were given a substance that looked, smelt, and tasted similar to the herbal medicine but which did not contain any active ingredients. The children and their parents were not told which treatment they were receiving. Children completed pre-treatment and post-treatment measures of attention, where higher scores show better attention.

The results of the study were as follows:

	Average pre-treatment score	Average post-treatment score	Results of the statistical test on the difference between pre- and post-treatment scores
Treatment group	85.6	97.9	$p < 0.05$
Control group	88.8	84.3	$p > 0.05$

(a) Identify:

(i) The dependent variable for the study (1 mark)

(ii) The independent variable for the study (1 mark)

(b) (i) State the conclusion that the researchers could draw from the results for the Treatment group. (1 mark)

(ii) State the conclusion that the researchers could draw from the results for the Control group. (1 mark)

(c) Explain why the Control group was given an inactive substance. (2 marks)

Question 3

(8 marks)

- (a) Outline what is meant by the term 'informed consent' in research in psychology.

(1 mark)

- (b) (i) How would a psychologist define the term 'confidentiality'?

(1 mark)

- (ii) Give **two (2)** reasons why confidentiality is important in research in psychology.

(2 marks)

- (c) Psychologists use twin studies and adoption studies to study the effect of nature versus nurture on development. Explain **two (2)** ethical issues that a psychologist would have to consider when conducting this kind of research.

(4 marks)

End of Section One

See next page

Section Two: Short answer

50% (50 Marks)

This section has **five (5)** questions. Answer **all** questions. Write your answers in the spaces provided.

Spare pages are included at the end of this booklet. They can be used as additional space if required to continue an answer. If you need to use the space to continue an answer, indicate in the original answer space where the answer is continued, i.e. give the page number. Fill in the number of the question(s) that you are continuing to answer at the top of the page.

Suggested working time: 90 minutes.

Question 4: Biological influences**(10 marks)**

- (a) Name **one (1)** neurotransmitter and describe **one (1)** effect of this on the human nervous system.

(2 marks)

- (b) Explain how neurotransmitters work in communicating messages between neurons.

(4 marks)

- (c) (i) Name **two (2)** research techniques that are used to study the nervous system in humans or animals.

(2 marks)

- (ii) Explain the significance of research involving animals to the understanding of the anatomy and physiology of the human brain. (2 marks)

Question 5: Cognition**(10 marks)**

- (a) Describe **two (2)** ways in which human cognitive processing can be related to the working of a computer. (2 marks)

- (b) (i) Name **two (2)** cognitive skills. (2 marks)

- (ii) Give **one (1)** example of how **each** cognitive skill identified in Question 5(b)(i) could be shown in a person's behaviour. (2 marks)

- (c) Name and describe **two (2)** behaviour modification strategies that can be used to change behaviour in people with ADHD. (4 marks)

Question 6: Communication**(10 marks)**

- (a) Explain what is meant by the term 'communication style'.

(2 marks)

- (b) Name **two (2)** of the three social skills identified by Robinson and give an example of how each is used by adults to regulate their social relationships.

(4 marks)

- (c) Describe **two (2)** examples of parent-child interactions that can assist with learning language.

(4 marks)

Question 7: Relational Influences**(10 marks)**

- (a) Explain how psychologists define the term 'conflict'. (1 mark)

- (b) Explain **one (1)** disadvantage that can result when someone imposes a solution on people in a conflict. (2 marks)

- (c) State **three (3)** advantages of using mediation to resolve conflict in a relationship. (3 marks)

- (d) Describe **two (2)** ways that counselling can help people to resolve conflict in a relationship. (4 marks)

Question 8: Social Values and Practice**(10 marks)**

- (a) Identify **two (2)** types of 'family'.

(2 marks)

- (b) Describe **two (2)** changes in social values that have led to changes in the accepted definition of a family.

(4 marks)

- (c) Select an example of a social issue and explain how **two (2)** social values come into conflict around this issue. (Examples of social issues might include, but are not restricted to, abortion, euthanasia, commercial development of environmentally sensitive areas).

(4 marks)

End of Section Two**See next page**

Section Three: Extended answer**30% (40 Marks)**

This section contains **two (2)** questions. You must answer **both** questions.

Pages are included at the end of the two questions for planning and writing your answers.

- Planning: If you use a page for planning, indicate this clearly at the top of the page.
- Answering the question: In the pages provided indicate clearly the question number you are answering.

Suggested working time: 60 minutes.

Question 9**(20 marks)****Ivory Coast: Charity Fears Refugee Crisis**

"Liberia is experiencing a refugee crisis following violence in neighbouring Ivory Coast ... Oxfam believes more than 100 000 people have poured over the border since the fighting between rival armies began"
(Cavanagh, 2011)

How can the psychology of personality and social psychology assist us in understanding social values about refugees?

In constructing your answer, you should develop a logical argument that demonstrates an understanding of factors related to self, others, and society and their interaction. Include relevant psychological evidence.

Question 10**(20 marks)**

'The mental health of young people is as much an issue for the community as it is for the individual.'

Evaluate this statement with reference to psychological understandings related to self, others, and society and their interaction. Include relevant psychological evidence.

End of questions

Question number _____

[illegible]

Question number _____

[illegible]

Question number _____

[illegible]

Question number _____

[illegible]

Question number_____

[illegible]

Question number _____

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Question number _____

[illegible]

Question number _____

[illegible]

Additional working space

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[illegible]

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

Section One

- Question 2** Data source from: Katz, M., Adar Levine, A., Kol-Degani, H., & Kav-Venaki, L. (2010). A compound herbal preparation (CHP) in the treatment of children with ADHD: A randomized controlled trial. *Journal of Attention Disorders*, (14, 281-291. DOI: 10.1177/1087054709356388).

Section Three

- Question 9** Cavanagh, R. (2011, April 16). *Ivory Coast: Charity fears refugee crisis*. Retrieved July, 2011, from <http://news.sky.com/home/world-news/article/15973571>.

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